[redacted]

WAR DEPARTMENT
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INCOMING MESSAGE

EYES ONLY

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DECLASSIFIED
State Dept. Letter, 10-5-72.

By R. H. Parks Date 10-10-72

From: Chungking
To : War

No : 955, 23 December 1943

Eyes alone for Marshall from Hearn for delivery. "President Franklin D Roosevelt.

I have received your telegram of December 21st. Since our meeting at Cairo, I have been even more keenly aware of your friendly assistance to and deep concern for China, and have therefore accepted your suggestion of delaying our all out offensive in Burma until we can have a large scale amphibious operation as outlined in your telegram of December 7th. As regards the general strategy decided by the British American council of Chiefs of Staff to use all available resources to defeat Germany first, I was not present during the deliberations and was therefore not in position to express my views. I place the greatest confidence in the soundness of your judgment. I must however say quite frankly that judging by the latest military dispositions and activities the Allied strategy of relegating the China War Theater to the background has given rise to serious misgivings on all sides. The success or failure of the Burma campaign is a matter of life and death for China. You will recall that while at Cairo I emphasized the fact that to dispatch our Yunnan troops to begin operations in south Burma to outflank the enemy is to court disaster-a plan of campaign to which I am unable to agree. However, whatever Chinese forces which could be used in the Burma campaign without vitally affecting the China theater of War, such as the Ledo and Ramgarh troops, I have already turned over to Mountbatten and Stilwell. While sharing your view that very long range air operations against Japan proper from China should do much to heighten the morale of both our Nations, I am strongly of the opinion that in order to assure the success of these operations the present American Air Force stationed in China should be immediately increased to such an extent as to be able to protect our air bases

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From: Chungking
To : War

No : 955, 23 December1943

from attack or destruction by the enemy. As a Military man, I feel constrained to acquaint you with the actual situation as it exists today. The coming year is the most critical year for the China theater of war both from the military and the economic point of view and I am apprehensive lest the unfavorable turn of events in this theater should affect the whole war situation in the Pacific. Signed Chiang Kai Shek ".

No Sig

ACTION: WHITE HOUSE

CM-IN-14570 (23 Dec 43) 1535Z bjm

DECLASSIFIED
State Dept. Letter, 10-5-72
By R. H. Parks Date 10-10-72

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